

the chrysanthemum-petal plate, whose mouth just like a chrysanthemum in full blossom. There were also the melon-ridge-shaped, the cherry-(apple)-shaped, and the lotus-seedpod-shaped vases, pots and dishes, all making people recall something or enjoy in retrospect. The characteristics of modelling of Yongzheng Reign included: the general outlines of the body were mainly in curves and only some in straight lines, making the lines mild and delightful. The transition of each part of the utensil was gentle, without any obvious turning line and with a well-proportioned ratio. The *Ruyi Zun* had a rounded and plump body from the upper to the lower, with its waist girdled, its slender figure full of grace, and its ribbon-like *Ruyi*-shaped handles attached high between the mouth and waist, adding more elegance to the utensil.

The patterns during Yongzheng Reign were mainly of the flowers and birds. Among them, the begonia pattern, and the corn-poppy pattern were in vogue, with graceful looks, charming and touching, which were the typical examples for the style and features of the time. Other examples such as the pattern of two mandarin ducks playing the lotus, the pattern of magpies atop the plum tree, the pattern of many pomegranate fruits opening, and the quails and ammonoid pattern all contained the meanings of wealth, happiness, auspiciousness and satisfaction by symbolic, implied, metaphoric, homophonic methods.

As for layout of design, the patterns were scattered and refreshing, the forms of drawing were terse and reserved. The design of the flower "stretching from the outer to inner surface of the porcelain" led to the reverie of that "the garden was gay and overflowed with blossoms of every hue, and there was a spray of red plum branch stretching out of the wall." The pictures of ladies were strong in delicate and slender features while the drawings of landscape (mountains and waters) were marked by its serenity, seclusion and spaciousness.

The harmonious unity of the modelling, layout of patterns and the decorative beauty represented by the flowers-and-birds of *Fencai* formed into the artistic style of Yongzheng Reign porcelain -- ***the beauty of prettiness and gracefulness.***

During Qianlong Reign, the overglaze colour, the underglaze colour, and the colour glaze of various kinds were cross-used and co-ordinated with each other in the same utensil, and the skills were more diversified and exquisite and the technique became more perfect. Many of them came out of queer ideas and were made by "divine" workmanship, emerging in an endless stream, and making people get lost in wonder.

ENGRAVING PORCELAIN It was made so as to hollow out and chase various patterns on an unglazed body of utensil, and then to decorate it both overglaze and underglaze. This type of porcelain included the incense burner (*Xun*, or censer), the flower-basket, and the lantern-chimney; all with variously shaped heart-revolving and neck-revolving vases. The heart-revolving vase had inner and outer layers, with exquisite chased or openworked patterns of the cloud-dragon, the flower-wood and the window bar on the shoulder of outer layer and with vertebrate and precisely-made revolving device in the inner vase. Through the openwork-hole, the revolving patterns on the inner vase could be seen with too much for the eyes to feast on. Usually the outer vase was also painted with *Fencai* pattern, or the blue glazed and gilt pattern, or the *Qinghua* pattern on yellow ground, so grotesque and diversified for the viewers to clap the hands in applause.

PORCELAIN IN SHAPE OF ANIMAL AND PLANT AND THE IMITATIONS OF VARIOUS KINDS OF ART WARES

All tried to imitate the shapes, colours and characters of objects in the nature by applying all means and selecting all types of glaze-colour pigments. The porcelain shaped livings like chicken, duck, crane, elephant, crab, *Lingzhi*, pomegranate, litchi, cherry and peanut; the imitations of ancient bronze wares included *Ding*, *Gu*, *Zun* and so on; and the imitations of red engraved lacquerware, woodwares, bamboo-weaving wares, jades, emerald, coral, etc., all of the products looked genuine.

FENCAI AND ENAMEL Influenced by the realism of academy painting style in the imperial palace, the cheeks and facial organs of the figures and the turning and folding of clothes patterns had a strongly stereoscopic sense. The patterns of flowers were flourishing in the ground's colours, including the hundred flower ground, the veiled flower ground, the tapestry-like ground, the tapestry-like ground with colours, and so on. It was also in fashion to use needles to sketch out the patterns of creeping weeds of honeysuckle on the colourful ground, which was extremely exquisite and gorgeous, and thus called "Adding Flowers to Embroidery." The frames of the panels on the colourful ground were decorated with the flowers, the curled grasses and the *Ruyi* cloud, all gilt, fully adorned with brilliant jewels and pearls.

The modelling in Qianlong Reign was of novelty out of queerness and ingeniousness. The queerness indicated the heart-revolving vase, the neck-revolving vases, the *Jiaotai* (the celestial and the terrestrial in harmony) vase, the vase shaped livings, and the imitations of ancient handicraft wares, while the ingeniousness included the three-gourd vase, the four-gourd vase, the five-